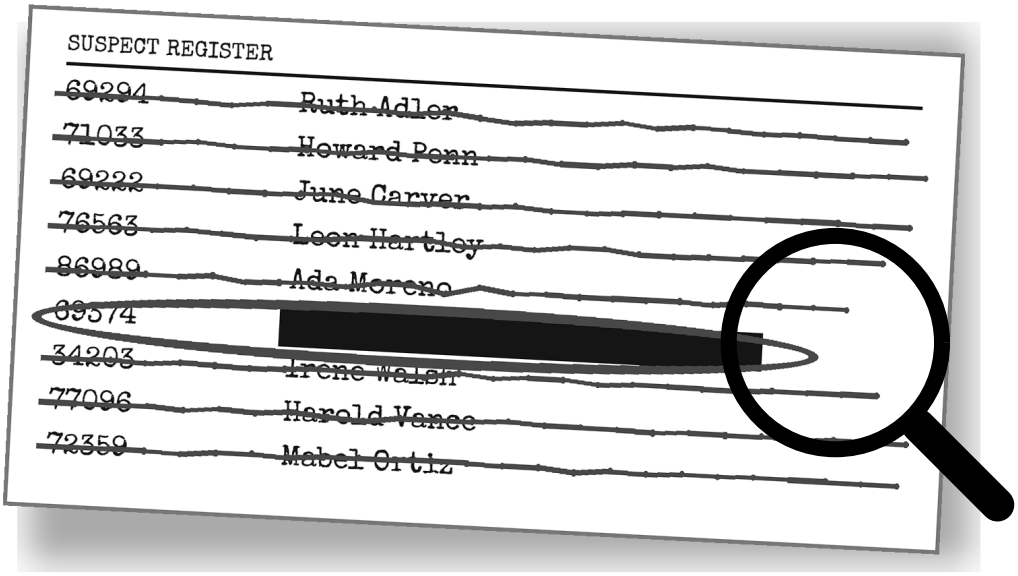
A LARGE PRINT MURDER MYSTERY PUZZLE BOOK

CROSS OUT THE KILLER

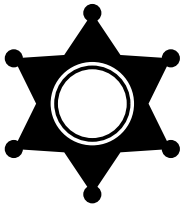
Death on the Magnolia Queen



BONUS CASE

800 SUSPECTS · 10 CLUES · 3 TESTS · 1 KILLER

FUN BOOKS PUBLISHER



Cross Out the Killer: Death on the Magnolia Queen

A Large Print Murder Mystery Puzzle Book

Bonus Case

Copyright © 2026 Fun Books Publisher. All rights reserved. First edition.

No part of this book may be reproduced or shared in any form without permission from the publisher, except for brief quotations in a review.

This is a work of fiction. The story, the places, the events and the organizations in it are imaginary and are not connected with any real event, venue, club, team or broadcaster. The names in the suspect register were built from public U.S. Census name lists and paired at random; any resemblance to real people is a coincidence.

The case has been checked by computer: there is exactly one killer, every clue is needed to narrow the register down to the finalists, and the answer is never printed in the book.

funbookpublisher.com

WELCOME, DETECTIVE

Thank you for choosing this book. Somewhere in these pages, among 800 names, one person committed a crime, and you are the only detective on the case.

Every clue is fair, a checkpoint after every clue keeps you on track, and the answer is never printed, so nothing can spoil the surprise. Take it one clue at a time. There is no rush.

Happy sleuthing,
the team at Fun Books Publisher

IN THIS CASE FILE

How to Play 4
A Quick Practice Case 5
The Case 6
Detective's Notebook 7
Part One: The Clues 8
The Suspect Register 14
Checking Tables 29
Part Two: The Case Files 30
The Deduction Sheet 38
Hints 39
Your Verdict Code 42

HOW TO PLAY

You are the detective. A crime has been committed at the Magnolia Queen, and the killer is one of the **800 people** in the Suspect Register, which comes right after the clues.

1. Read the case. The story tells you what happened.

2. Take the clues one at a time. Each clue tells you one true fact about the killer, and exactly what to cross out.

3. Go through the whole register and cross out every suspect who does not match the clue. Draw one straight line through the name, so you can still read it later.

4. Check your work. After every clue there is a **checkpoint**. If your numbers match, carry on. If not, look back over that clue before you move on.

5. Part One ends with 3 finalists. In **Part Two** you study the police case files to find out which of them is the killer. Part Two has its own instructions.

6. Check your answer with the Verdict Code at the end of the book.

You will need: a pen or a fine marker, good light, and a cup of something nice. A ruler or a bookmark helps you keep your place on the page.

Take your time. This is not a race. Most detectives solve a few clues a day.

A QUICK PRACTICE CASE

Here is a tiny register with only six suspects, already solved, so you can see how it works before you start the real case.

TICKET	NAME	AGE	CROSSED OUT BY
~~41207~~	~~Ann Lee~~	~~34~~	Clue 1
~~52818~~	~~Bob Hart~~	~~67~~	Clue 3
~~63544~~	~~Ida Moss~~	~~45~~	Clue 2
~~70132~~	~~Tom Reyes~~	~~52~~	Clue 3
~~81936~~	~~Eve Cole~~	~~28~~	Clue 1
90217	Joe Park	71	**THE KILLER**

Clue 1. The killer is 40 years old or older. Cross out Ann (34) and Eve (28).

Clue 2. The killer's ticket number contains the digit 1. Cross out Ida, because her ticket, 63544, has no 1 in it.

Clue 3. The killer's ticket number is odd. Cross out Bob (52818) and Tom (70132). Only Joe Park is left.

That is all there is to it. The real case works exactly the same way, just with a great many more suspects. Good luck, detective.

CASE FILE

DEATH ON THE MAGNOLIA QUEEN

Every summer the Magnolia Queen, the last great paddle steamer on the Mississippi, sails out of Natchez for her famous Saturday night dinner cruise: a jazz band, crab cakes, and eight hundred passengers in their best clothes.

This year was Captain Silas Merrow's last cruise. After forty years at the wheel, he had promised to end the night by opening the ship's old safe in front of everyone, and to tell who had really sold him the "lost" riverboat log that made the Magnolia Queen famous.

At twenty past nine, the first mate found the captain dead in his cabin. He had been struck from behind. The safe was open, and the old log was gone.

Every passenger had a numbered boarding ticket, and the purser's register lists all eight hundred of them: ticket number, name and age. The boat had not touched the shore since it left Natchez. The killer was still on board.

This short bonus case works exactly like the books. In **Part One**, the clues will help you cross out the innocent until only three **finalists** are left. In **Part Two**, the purser's files will tell you which of the three did it.

DETECTIVE'S NOTEBOOK

Check off each clue when you have finished it. It helps when you come back another day.

- ☐ Clue 1 _____
- ☐ Clue 2 _____
- ☐ Clue 3 _____
- ☐ Clue 4 _____
- ☐ Clue 5 _____
- ☐ Clue 6 _____
- ☐ Clue 7 _____
- ☐ Clue 8 _____
- ☐ Clue 9 _____
- ☐ Clue 10 _____

MY NOTES

PART ONE: THE CLUES

EVIDENCE #1

Clue 1 of 10

The killer had a first name stitched onto a souvenir napkin at the embroidery table, and the needle broke halfway through. The half-napkin left in the Captain's Cabin shows only one clear letter of the first name: an E.

The killer's FIRST name contains the letter E.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose first name has no letter E.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, page 19 should have **25** names left and page 28 should have **28**. To check any other page, use the Checking Tables on page 29.

EVIDENCE #2

Clue 2 of 10

Boarding tickets with a 1 in the number were printed on the old machine, which punches a star-shaped hole; all the others got a round hole. A corner of the killer's ticket, too small to show any numbers, was found under the captain's desk. Its hole is round.

The killer's ticket number does not contain the digit 1.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose ticket number has a 1 anywhere in it.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, page 19 should have **15** names left and page 21 should have **18**. To check any other page, use the Checking Tables on page 29.

EVIDENCE #3

Clue 3 of 10

The "Young at Heart" dance contest was open only to passengers aged 55 or younger, and every dancer wore a numbered paper badge. The killer's dance badge was found torn off by the cabin door. The number on it is smudged beyond reading.

The killer is 55 years old or younger.

What to do: Cross out every suspect older than 55.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **123** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #4

Clue 4 of 10

The gangway scanner could not read tickets with an 8 in the number, so those passengers had their ticket stamped by hand in purple ink. The same corner of the killer's ticket has no purple ink on it.

> **The killer's ticket number does not contain the digit 8.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose ticket number has an 8 anywhere in it.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **69** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #5

Clue 5 of 10

The killer signed the captain's guest book for the safe opening. A glass of iced tea was knocked over it, and only one letter of the last name can still be read: an A.

> **The killer's LAST name contains the letter A.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose last name has no letter A.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **41** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #6

Clue 6 of 10

The purser stamps a last name on every brass luggage tag, from a box of metal letters that has been missing its S for years; names with an S get a paper tag instead. The killer's luggage tag, left on the captain's chair, is brass, and the name has been scratched off.

> **The killer's LAST name does not contain the letter S.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose last name contains the letter S.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **26** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #7

Clue 7 of 10

Passengers with a ticket ending in 0, 1, 2, 3 or 4 boarded through the lower gangway and got a blue wristband; everyone else boarded through the upper gangway and got a yellow one. A snapped blue wristband was found by the open safe, torn off the killer's wrist in a hurry.

> **The LAST digit of the killer's ticket is 0, 1, 2, 3 or 4.**
>
> **What to do:** Cross out every suspect whose ticket ends in 5, 6, 7, 8 or 9.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **12** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #8

Clue 8 of 10

The purser's seating cards have six printed boxes for a last name, and longer names run along the bottom edge. The killer's seating card was found in the cabin, smudged by the rain, but there is nothing written along the bottom edge.

The killer's LAST name has 6 letters or fewer.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose last name has more than 6 letters.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **8** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #9

Clue 9 of 10

The bar prints each guest's first name on a cocktail stirrer, and the printer had no letter O all night, so any name with an O got a plain stirrer. The killer's stirrer, left in the captain's glass, is printed, although the river damp has washed the letters away.

The killer's FIRST name does not contain the letter O.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose first name contains the letter O.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **5** suspects should be left in the whole register.

EVIDENCE #10

Clue 10 of 10

A scrap of the killer's ticket was caught in the hinge of the safe door. Only one digit survives on it: a 7.

The killer's ticket number contains the digit 7.

What to do: Cross out every suspect whose ticket number has no 7 in it.

CHECKPOINT. When you have finished this clue, exactly **3** suspects should be left in the whole register. These are your **finalists**. Write their names and ticket numbers in the box on page 30, then turn to Part Two.

TICKET	NAME	AGE
10076	Greta Holley	70
10136	Allen Million	72
10282	Kendrick Murphy	47
10370	Alisha Hancock	29
10409	George Groth	69
10506	Rhonda Sangster	33
10546	Marian Ruiz	81
10602	Freddie Day	37
10826	Kathleen Lovins	38
10977	William Cromer	22
11155	Angela Reed	82
11314	Orville Webster	64
11332	Jeremy Templin	67
11379	Peter Rector	38
11440	Jillian Soni	28
11565	Spencer Cheshire	67
11681	Tom Bergstrom	19
11718	Paulette Dexter	55
11886	Hubert Branum	18
12114	Jason Fabela	70
12167	Troy Wimer	68
12184	Charles Frazer	25
12602	Ross Henke	20
12646	Blanca Corder	73
12653	Eleanor Roybal	75
12829	Douglas Anthony	85
12911	Joanne Lambright	31
13053	Bridget Hail	59
13153	Mary Townsend	58
13201	Louise Ayala	72
13296	Fred Fetzer	77
13354	Sadie Figueroa	78
13495	Kristi Leflore	71
13656	Edwin Kirkendall	76
13921	Jaclyn Wolfe	91
13927	Lupe Heil	36
14152	Jimmie Navarro	61
14163	Sandra Meunier	64
14171	Jerry Grover	42
14202	Harry Gallagher	29
14323	Isaac Rubio	57
14325	Mae Lima	38
14400	Rose Purdy	20
14779	Cathleen Salcido	18
14973	Suzanne Casto	55
15006	Quinton Dai	72
15069	Alan Reynoso	42
15078	Jana Canas	32
15103	Anna Moody	33
15328	Anthony Loos	18
15337	Candy Terrell	52
15358	Roberta Mello	70
15396	Harvey Marie	67
15621	Sidney Blakely	22

TICKET	NAME	AGE
15630	Mia Arnette	48
15743	Robbie Perry	71
15744	Deborah Stuart	42
15796	Annie Beers	32
16000	Willie Gallegos	63
16243	Marcus Wallace	77
16252	Jennifer Crozier	23
16411	Andrew Nelsen	73
16504	Anne Renaud	73
16629	Joanna Edwards	36
16737	Jeremy Barbee	69
16819	Mario Keene	83
17164	Jessica Perkins	18
17273	Nathan Cyr	37
17475	Benjamin Sigler	32
17758	Peter Curlee	32
17804	Susanna Swank	85
17819	Wilma Cooper	79
18142	Gerald Dean	56
18249	Rogelio Perreira	30
18350	Scott Koh	62
18997	Alex Monaghan	34
19198	Hugh Haigh	92
19326	Raymond Kittle	46
19663	Jamie Wayland	29
19753	Melody Ingersoll	90
19829	Amelia Beavers	59
19932	Ron Salzman	27
19951	Kevin Carman	69
20030	Juan Miles	47
20092	Jeanette Mosher	88
20322	Alice Bullard	80
20605	Dudley Cobb	89
20703	Ethan Mendez	65
20805	Justin Marte	63
21191	Tabitha Stickley	58
21502	Brian Oehler	87
21566	Kathleen Paugh	28
21670	Beverly Reynaga	44
21929	Lester Bobb	63
22034	Taylor Baptiste	50
22106	Flora Boyle	86
22171	Gail Boykin	28
22205	Kellie Rivas	26
22263	Dollie Sutter	48
22311	Arthur Hussain	57
22336	Dominic Palacios	57
22457	Colette Seyler	31
22524	Julie Hose	60
22603	Christine Craine	72
22785	Spencer Persaud	33
22899	Wesley Kuhn	31
22919	David Guinn	85
22991	Iva Gant	28

TICKET	NAME	AGE
22994	Hugo Williams	41
23328	Kyle Carrera	72
23370	Frances Santiago	27
23411	Patrick Strunk	32
23553	Mary Dias	39
23809	Lloyd Conners	79
23813	Miguel Pokorny	78
24099	Brenda Quiros	84
24125	Darwin Galvan	30
24174	Karen Ramos	53
24267	Dorthy Rosales	54
24286	Geneva Mickel	79
24379	Trenton Pittman	59
24442	Reynaldo Scales	19
24585	Tammy Carlino	29
24970	Curtis Mosher	46
25323	Valerie Olivas	57
25476	Eugenia Loo	26
25527	Jefferson Betz	68
25609	Alta Rojo	77
25675	Don Renaud	80
25689	Ahmad Holz	22
26046	Caroline Mora	85
26064	Sylvia Kollar	91
26309	Alisha Moran	25
26337	Helen Moralez	23
26436	Archie Guzman	57
26484	Wade Demko	54
26565	Desmond Hennen	26
26774	Delia Carbajal	19
26795	Barbara Beech	19
26890	Rena Peer	44
26949	Beulah Burch	54
26953	Vernon Selman	45
27017	Edwin Ullrich	44
27080	Juana Arsenault	73
27162	Lana Alves	84
27177	Roxanne Tidd	71
27255	Louise Raney	74
27466	Delmar Frierson	69
27675	Ricky Gadsden	90
27860	Charles Calloway	74
28084	Alfonso Hartman	27
28282	Salvador Reed	88
28294	Gilbert Graziano	77
28298	Anna Overmyer	32
28448	Micheal Carley	48
28563	Joe Mudd	91
28708	Sherrie Newby	24
28730	Marcella Cicero	20
28825	Doyle Cassady	82
28872	Ann Moeller	18
28984	Douglas Barlow	46
29026	Issac Vasquez	64

TICKET	NAME	AGE
29158	Bridget Kline	35
29723	Jordan Janney	22
29936	Kay Leung	40
29955	Laurie Copeland	66
30011	Winnie Kuang	43
30019	Tom Nussbaum	43
30057	Jarrod Wells	70
30319	Gail Maggard	89
30811	Juanita Reeder	55
30903	Stacy Kellogg	18
31006	Audrey Arenas	45
31095	Daphne Simeone	79
31218	Vicky Bice	78
31461	Carroll Felix	57
31498	Ross Bunn	85
31658	Juan Creed	46
31703	Erika Hamblen	36
31726	Kathie Patterson	51
31927	Tracy Wolfe	88
31985	Shari Butler	86
32052	Robyn Ness	72
32090	Darlene Iglesias	70
32116	Walter Eldridge	77
32159	Priscilla Ang	38
32163	Ron Rubalcaba	38
32235	Roland Wilke	85
32706	Vernon Casarez	69
32770	Pam Polo	39
32943	Devin Stilwell	36
32948	David Mundo	69
33037	Orville Heil	48
33066	Susan Chacon	43
33092	Jeanine Copeland	65
33197	Virgil Rayfield	38
33274	Deborah Rodden	62
33410	Tina Vallee	48
33566	Gabriel Federico	36
33749	Meghan Leger	18
33808	Latasha Trinh	37
33864	John Lindquist	50
33871	Harold Staats	44
33992	Johnie Bozeman	33
34022	Ruth Bell	40
34077	Tabitha Nasir	45
34128	Veronica Whipple	57
34433	Avis Decker	38
34488	Flossie Sheely	66
34779	Trevor Shivers	56
34788	Christina Luna	64
34926	Danial Free	42
35127	Catalina Cyr	61
35273	Robin Feder	65
35432	Leah Paredes	18
35471	Boyd Araya	63

TICKET	NAME	AGE
35496	Clement Poland	42
35512	Isaac Richard	46
35532	Reginald Hooks	60
35587	Jarrod Chung	74
35703	Dwayne Misner	59
36009	Misty Enderle	83
36036	Alvaro Yoder	22
36053	Martina Lobb	46
36113	Angelina Nunez	73
36213	Howard Fuerst	51
36317	Joel Waite	64
36346	Theresa Hornsby	53
36351	Heather Dearman	51
36415	Bruce Rioux	68
36435	Mattie Greenman	37
36501	Lori Munoz	36
36609	Diane Loza	64
36633	Heidi Knowles	57
36906	Antonia Treadway	34
36925	Roger Godoy	61
37199	Georgette Yowell	36
37217	Stacy Higgins	23
37435	Renee Levenson	86
37573	Angie New	34
37791	Robert Leong	62
38060	Simon Aparicio	71
38065	Harvey Frisbie	19
38128	Jason Malcolm	25
38142	Angie Bonham	42
38336	Robert Hansen	88
38392	Danny Zamudio	19
38395	Ebony Eng	73
38450	Bruce Nickelson	57
38594	Dee Cancino	48
38653	Dolores Stiner	29
38705	Isidro Berg	41
38797	Neal Calkins	56
38919	Leland Eversole	29
38973	Inez Carlson	61
39048	Jamie Ball	38
39074	Tara Backes	73
39173	Rachelle Huerta	43
39184	Beatrice Webb	48
39203	Antonia Martinez	21
39267	Miriam Beatty	85
39305	Orlando Aylward	62
39328	Carlos Purnell	30
39465	Jolene Oney	25
39521	Graham Valdes	70
39543	Adam Marquez	62
39636	Misty Ingram	65
39669	Glen Brewer	86
39672	Alton Hamlett	91
39739	Minerva Robles	20

TICKET	NAME	AGE
39816	Vicki Herring	27
39840	Vivian Tostado	92
39863	Dominique Braden	18
39880	Spencer Pilcher	89
39896	Earnest Cole	81
40058	Gail Marie	45
40083	Vera Gillen	37
40185	Marlene Lillie	51
40261	Jill Stansbury	38
40345	Cecelia Burton	76
40366	Kenneth Shope	19
40374	Marion Dudley	43
40473	Yvonne Carswell	65
40485	Curtis Glaze	85
40638	Ronnie Bruns	78
40660	Todd Nicola	29
40929	George Wagner	37
41132	Carrie Jasso	80
41519	Elise Nunez	19
41549	Sam Simonton	73
41662	Juan Ortega	59
41681	Arlene Dupre	78
41985	Norbert Horne	37
42126	James Worth	51
42183	Nettie Reid	33
42592	Conrad Flores	47
42754	Sam Stucker	27
42888	Brian Reimann	32
43052	Regina Yetter	90
43125	Conrad Curley	90
43145	Alma Jones	92
43168	Ramona Zelaya	49
43367	Anna Pederson	83
43385	Stacie Callanan	63
43476	April Soileau	52
43648	Jimmy Hatch	31
43649	Jarrod Enriquez	37
44112	Darius Bryant	88
44201	Ruth Perlman	48
44287	Matt Temple	28
44501	Rita Alonso	69
44559	Bessie Whiteman	72
44649	Sam Peck	80
44671	Omar Maloy	22
44728	Billie Daniell	60
45086	Rafael Petrucci	33
45129	Jesus Buckles	88
45218	Herman Monzon	73
45569	Brandi Bradford	55
45715	Dorothy Hall	49
45750	Kurt Wojtowicz	76
45898	Jackie Ervin	89
45946	Mia Fife	77
46101	Vince Crozier	46

TICKET	NAME	AGE
46189	Marty Diller	19
46479	Leila Aguirre	92
46511	Roxie Plata	57
46633	Gordon Sunday	88
46699	Wilma Haack	81
46751	Wade Llewellyn	37
46754	Elise Moser	71
46791	Rachel Estep	47
46802	Rena Conrad	62
46952	Sue Rogers	26
47156	Jenna Broussard	83
47223	Everett Blakely	73
47224	Chasity Arellano	74
47363	Brandi Weimer	56
47474	Caleb Henley	61
47480	Yvette Marler	47
47494	Danny Heinrich	19
47817	Bobbie Thorn	68
47941	Melissa Lauer	86
48043	Teresa Simpson	49
48144	Jesse Lafayette	57
48177	Mark Rowden	83
48222	Derick Cheng	40
48278	Norman Silvas	69
48283	Wilfred Bruch	82
48326	Lucille Rendon	31
48507	Dwayne Cardozo	53
48509	Darrell Matthews	47
48556	Bill Fuller	31
48615	Madge Grove	66
48641	William Walden	39
48741	Katrina Patel	69
49086	Leah Bull	40
49089	Lucy Knepp	52
49226	Alicia Dye	91
49251	Leon Finnegan	69
49302	Norris Iorio	37
49515	Omar Aparicio	21
49913	Rudolph Thorn	29
50165	Roman Enright	78
50232	Hector Musser	75
50291	Benny Strait	65
50479	Debra Hartley	69
50500	Roman Emmons	30
50531	Yolanda Earl	58
50657	Joseph Draughn	46
50689	Paul Zuniga	46
50912	Benjamin Pinto	74
50931	Suzanne Quinonez	22
51005	Devon Schofield	76
51057	Donna Jeffrey	25
51164	Robert Bains	75
51327	Sylvia Hunley	58
51382	Lisa Jerez	24

TICKET	NAME	AGE
51467	Harriet Newell	23
51580	Melody Jewell	74
51734	Robert Balch	28
51776	Norbert Scofield	92
51871	Norma Curiel	85
52109	Pauline Arneson	57
52293	Logan Shell	45
52425	Keri Hanlon	72
52476	Nick Driver	47
52516	Marjorie Suter	68
52660	Everette Scanlan	26
52691	Nicholas Perkins	65
52954	Amber Boley	31
53098	Bobbie Foley	54
53117	Herbert Delariva	85
53234	Norman Gurley	86
53364	Sylvia Horvath	67
53539	Marie Turnbull	92
53593	Mary Weigand	59
53617	Kim Armstrong	69
53651	Nicole Kinsey	77
53800	Shirley Hussey	75
53970	Daniel Langford	64
54191	Heidi Christy	81
54203	Daniel Barron	30
54240	Ruben Lemaster	66
54257	Kerri Miles	56
54297	Burt Legg	90
54342	Sylvester Stokes	39
54375	April Zamarripa	66
54462	Dewayne Barney	75
54545	Latisha Waiters	26
54651	Paula Rico	86
54821	Lucille Camp	80
54922	Irving Chang	77
54962	Terrie Scales	82
55037	Donnie Brim	58
55066	Michael Silva	74
55169	Andrea Markovich	38
55258	Delia Parker	29
55333	Juanita Murphree	33
55508	Vicky Edmundson	78
55534	Mona Huffman	73
55802	Lloyd Huie	58
55815	Stella Kelsch	57
55825	Nancy Amey	73
55912	Vicki Job	34
55934	Lizzie Brister	64
56167	Randall Levesque	22
56264	Dick Bolster	44
56414	Stan Behrens	35
56823	Gail Parnell	22
56940	Delbert Rios	89
56955	David Hutchinson	45

TICKET	NAME	AGE
57141	Truman Dickinson	74
57382	Toni Outlaw	18
57478	Mark Griffin	19
57480	Lloyd Hershman	68
57599	Vicki Gay	85
57715	Norman Wing	46
57740	Nicole Adler	31
57816	Richard Holzer	73
57977	Pedro Pasco	23
58019	Kevin Looper	85
58035	Ivy Fonseca	37
58224	Valerie Lynn	62
58295	Janis Fidler	47
58312	Nell Cockrell	70
58541	Clair Woodard	58
58547	Tonya Woodring	58
58618	Kelley Osborn	66
58634	Maria Macias	47
58804	Glenn Nelson	34
58929	Norman Hocker	62
58964	Todd Benn	39
59224	Sophie Marks	51
59291	Patrice Messina	45
59324	Donna Ruiz	87
59341	Velma Kiely	52
59596	Craig Rafferty	62
59953	Heather Malcolm	73
60034	Francis Eiler	65
60047	Ted Granger	89
60229	Willard Alanis	61
60387	Ronda Winchester	26
60899	Tonya Miner	70
61180	Mable Adair	73
61418	Tina Button	45
61591	Harold Barnum	36
61987	Basil Mundt	73
62193	Ralph Mann	62
62302	Sean Branch	32
62367	Victor Rincon	49
62554	Deirdre Phillips	74
62638	Joyce Labelle	29
62712	Tammy Irwin	58
62839	Wilbur Day	18
63095	Shelley Aston	77
63112	Pedro Lee	74
63115	Brett Gregory	84
63235	Eva Cherry	68
63249	Milton Branham	43
63474	Aline Mohamed	91
63614	Dustin Center	40
63778	Willard Leos	52
63792	Patsy Santoyo	45
63944	Mark Davidson	67
64353	Traci Murrell	31

TICKET	NAME	AGE
64448	Celeste Johnson	84
64477	Ismael Millen	48
64490	Sue Session	76
64700	Emmett Sanchez	83
65171	Rosa Gluck	31
65193	Anna Levenson	51
65325	Jonas Loehr	77
65347	Marissa Trapp	90
65455	Pauline Ragland	84
65492	Latasha Medley	23
65519	Evelyn Watkins	19
65603	Terry Bradshaw	20
65654	Joan Force	77
65659	Paula Patton	28
65662	Rick Lubin	35
65686	Donald Crawford	77
65715	Erika Jaramillo	35
65734	Adeline Migliore	37
65872	Shanna Shannon	51
65884	Vincent Rivers	46
66097	Hazel Bolin	79
66226	Rob Sayles	60
66287	Ruth Mayo	38
66429	Louis Bedford	68
66709	Felicia Mason	58
66839	Gavin Glass	71
66986	Joyce Dwyer	82
67055	Clara Reynolds	56
67067	Nathan Trapani	18
67187	Wallace Strozier	58
67227	Jerri Cain	24
67340	Dion Files	75
67500	Clifton Godfrey	43
67518	Augustine Wesley	42
67869	Darrell Ulrich	46
67950	Justine Karim	40
68353	Jonathan Marrufo	57
68591	Melissa Hamer	27
68603	Marcus Minter	35
68610	Andre Bee	87
68716	Javier Dugger	58
68766	Ashley Bogan	75
68953	Ernestine Sawyer	67
68986	Loretta Boyce	25
69193	Theodore Switzer	76
69245	Wanda Zerbe	42
69341	Casey Bond	26
69483	Ron Griffin	45
69531	Tamara Shaffer	87
69656	Leona Verma	32
69712	Byron Beringer	64
70023	Bill Franks	26
70037	Nicholas Aranda	80
70039	Tommy Woosley	22

TICKET	NAME	AGE
70057	Carol Mahar	71
70187	Ben Spaulding	25
70206	Debora Simmons	20
70254	Vera Soriano	60
70308	Anton Loyd	51
70397	Kari Brand	75
70411	Cathy Redmon	44
70443	Erich Reaves	39
70504	Fred Ramirez	51
70556	Art Lawson	84
70611	Grant Whitt	91
70790	Katherine Lacour	78
71136	Meredith Wear	29
71329	Nadia Baeza	60
71366	Irene Amey	73
71406	Derrick Bilodeau	29
71604	Mason Bertrand	48
71758	Ann Kennedy	40
71772	Gloria Bitner	44
71851	Emmett Wright	77
71948	Neal Dimaggio	33
72053	Dolores Matteson	36
72197	Ray Alexander	56
72516	Andre Guevara	29
72548	Patty Campuzano	28
72639	Brenda Southard	92
72710	Warren Arroyo	75
72746	Alfred Broadhead	68
72897	Mario Branum	83
73010	Emily Lawson	87
73069	Sherry Mackay	78
73370	Jeffry Bethea	43
73431	Adele Hurtado	30
73567	Jesse Whidden	87
73618	Taylor Weaver	21
73641	Melinda Bryan	28
73673	Maurice Gramajo	60
73726	Ruth Leroux	38
73855	Zachary Merrick	83
73894	Penny Tripp	83
73900	Kristy Lattimore	20
73928	Paula Adorno	74
73939	Kim Walker	89
74053	Cecelia Yohe	21
74072	Joe Kilbourne	46
74167	Carole Vang	34
74173	Brittany Swinney	51
74227	Gustavo Rider	24
74359	Marci Beagle	86
74477	Betty Dey	35
74760	Betsy Patel	61
74942	Roger Weinberger	48
74947	Jared Crabtree	81
74968	Michael Lashley	86

TICKET	NAME	AGE
75216	Mildred Lankford	41
75329	Vincent Mata	37
75488	Isidro Carlisle	54
75520	Kathrine Ransom	59
75611	Jess Steinberg	91
75661	Micheal Lehman	71
75683	Jimmie Ries	55
75865	Jane Carnahan	63
75914	Gil Ngo	91
75996	Angelina Brazell	46
76243	Josefina Warren	20
76364	Evan Harper	69
76468	Julie Schofield	28
76545	Sidney Boggess	57
76550	Morris Vice	75
76768	Ricky Berg	92
77022	Emil Werner	62
77119	Jeannine Graff	20
77192	Forrest Mullins	66
77245	Rebekah Lian	74
77318	Cathleen Orcutt	72
77540	Cherie Lyles	76
77565	Jeremy Whitaker	28
77621	James Rau	40
77652	Humberto Alley	32
77675	Lauren Mooney	46
77936	Carly Hardman	49
77954	Daniel Carlson	56
77972	Betty Lesniak	80
77980	Jay Haugen	37
78061	John Ely	24
78179	Lawrence Cope	36
78438	Vickie Gordon	64
78550	Suzette Thompson	20
78673	Josh Olivares	61
78905	Stewart Solis	48
79142	Renee Duffield	91
79265	Jodie Swick	80
79274	Jeremy Vaught	76
79377	Adele Tocco	73
79446	Kelly Spain	18
79543	Stacy Pecina	25
79684	Mitchel Yates	50
80082	Jason Colburn	41
80107	James Eads	18
80160	Melvin Briscoe	23
80228	Elma Canady	19
80238	Bradley Morgan	55
80345	Colette Strauss	69
80535	Gregorio Spivey	56
80662	Rosemary Barry	25
80768	Julio Kagan	85
80899	Crystal Swink	22
80967	Noemi Holder	77

TICKET	NAME	AGE
81007	Johnny Jacob	45
81023	Jessie Bridge	51
81039	Dominic Schaaf	61
81371	Julie Robertson	64
81453	Clyde Spain	37
81717	Ethel Frederick	58
81755	Debra Valentin	77
81840	June Yamasaki	57
81941	Alma Bailey	80
81953	Homer Sizemore	39
82143	Sonny Cornejo	45
82203	Johnathan Coon	43
82240	Kurtis Decicco	39
82328	Andrew Schwab	70
82391	Carmen Heston	68
82405	Fidel Lopez	54
82512	Marissa Ridenour	75
82953	Stacy Owsley	81
83022	Maggie Kircher	20
83240	Debra Fanning	55
83252	Muriel Jarrell	89
83254	Thelma Cabezas	75
83351	Jim Almond	27
83523	Charlene Hitch	21
83571	Kimberly Magill	23
83773	Brad Blakey	65
83854	Peter Lacour	77
83878	Roy Stafford	43
83963	Elena Nieto	88
83989	Loren Goree	48
84608	Janice Collins	45
84678	Rodrigo Fry	28
84821	Larry Shelley	84
84835	Carl Cueva	36
85052	Glenda Allain	61
85111	Fred Alonso	83
85247	Kimberly Rana	72
85297	Hillary Shawver	80
85500	Helen Roney	57
85559	Blake Torrez	71
85625	Sherry Eriksen	39
85685	Janna Killian	83
85796	Audrey Shelby	18
85871	Darwin Orman	80
85933	Terence Reamer	53
86260	Dennis Muller	57
86345	Keith Purnell	62
86762	Luis Rainey	90
87221	Amy Lightfoot	77
87442	Edwin Kleiman	66
87473	Chris Horak	80
87500	Morris Tisdale	59
88063	Levi Taber	30
88139	Latoya Laboy	42

TICKET	NAME	AGE
88365	Joe Helms	87
88382	Jennifer Olivo	90
88521	Myrtle Wolf	91
88915	Mariano Leavitt	76
89004	Maggie Palmer	32
89301	Lucinda Check	70
89406	Sally Baltazar	37
89433	Meredith Baer	92
89819	Damian Rolf	85
89969	Elvira Cann	32
90064	Randolph Rink	53
90234	Paul Silver	79
90805	Paige Forster	22
90895	Lucille Schwartz	27
91092	Cara Sweet	59
91189	Howard Goggins	46
91253	Tammy Dicken	60
91309	Aurora Garris	69
91332	Effie Buxton	88
91500	Frederick Fleck	36
91569	Rachel Eddleman	90
91776	Angela Turney	89
91854	Melissa Toribio	78
91856	Erwin Ramirez	68
91874	Gerard Avery	76
91925	Cameron Snedeker	59
91933	Mabel Beard	23
92035	Linda Curtin	75
92082	Joanne Hawkinson	72
92128	Lottie Wright	23
92170	Jean Ridings	47
92237	Samuel Nauman	49
92305	Darlene Sale	48
92417	Harry Ochoa	45
92624	Malcolm Mullen	65
92738	Karen Silvas	43
92809	Grady Fessler	58
92911	Roger Pass	47
92918	Erin Nall	50
92969	Juana Ashbaugh	92
93130	Bridget Lazenby	26
93158	Annie Macaulay	50
93271	Elvis Wojtowicz	38
93348	George Rojas	26
93367	Victor Currin	43
93443	Eugenia Sierra	31
93489	Myron Patterson	50
93651	Hubert Bolan	21
93668	John Brown	64
93766	Terry Welch	34
94243	Hiram Waldrop	67
94491	Loretta Mei	89
94531	Ruby Martinez	68
94637	Pamela Ladner	58

TICKET	NAME	AGE
94665	Federico Granata	26
95011	Joe Cook	26
95338	Alex Camacho	64
95401	Pat Florez	36
95455	Luis Stearns	34
95620	Edgar Callejas	54
95630	Sadie Testerman	89
95843	Pete Cassity	45
95880	Jose Eriksen	19
95905	Fred Newsom	36
95994	Rafael Hambrick	61
96035	Gilbert Valiente	38
96165	Leslie Marinez	79
96198	Kelly Cox	65
96323	Carol Freeland	67
96516	Dennis Irish	47
96864	Lea Calhoon	64
97095	Jane Sosa	58
97300	Hugh Anderson	85
97319	Amelia Hayes	87
97426	Tracy Gresham	53
97458	Fabian Diedrich	69
97495	Merlin Matute	83
97659	James Caton	90
97673	Marilyn Pope	81
97720	Mark Conrad	62
97795	Jack Helmuth	63
97981	Annette Bates	71
98058	Harris Judy	59
98648	Alfredo Rhone	78
98825	Marian Bohl	36
98827	Joyce Volk	76
98937	Liza Lohse	27
99009	Holly Runyon	67
99027	Frances Lee	82
99168	Chris Beaulieu	76
99237	Ann Degroot	74
99257	Kaye Corriveau	27
99411	Leticia Krouse	91
99459	Jackie Shoffner	41
99472	Meghan Hardin	46
99607	Augusta Lubbers	81
99794	Lillie Beaudry	20
99953	Kenneth Hulsey	81

CHECKING TABLES

How many names should be left on each register page after each clue. Find your page in the first column. The tables stop at Clue 2. After that, so few names are left that a table would point straight at the finalists; the checkpoints give the total for the whole register instead.

PAGE	Clue 1	Clue 2
14	31	0
15	32	11
16	31	27
17	21	13
18	32	22
19	25	15
20	31	17
21	30	18
22	21	13
23	27	18
24	32	20
25	42	31
26	32	22
27	34	15
28	28	21

PART TWO: THE CASE FILES

Well done, detective. Three finalists are left, and every one of them matches every clue. Now find out which of them killed Captain Silas Merrow.

The purser's staff copied the records in a hurry and wrote down only the **last three digits** of each ticket, never names. So first write down your three finalists and their full ticket numbers in the box below. Many other numbers appear in the files: they belong to people you crossed out in Part One, so you can ignore them. When a record's three digits match one of your finalists, it belongs to that finalist: the police have already checked.

The passenger records are **not complete**, so a finalist who is missing from them has done nothing wrong. What counts is a record that puts a finalist somewhere else at the wrong time. The last two files, for the paperweights and for the key cards, are complete lists.

The killer must pass all **three tests** on the next page. Each of the other finalists fails at least one.

MY FINALISTS

Ticket _____ Name _____

Ticket _____ Name _____

Ticket _____ Name _____

THE THREE TESTS

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

The captain was attacked in his cabin at some moment between **9:05 and 9:15 PM**. The killer had to be in the Captain's Cabin at that time.

How to check it: Look up the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in the passenger records (Files A to G). If a finalist was seen somewhere else at a time that makes it **impossible** to reach the Captain's Cabin between 9:05 and 9:15, using the walking times on the map, that finalist fails this test. Walking times are the same in both directions.

Example: someone seen in the Library at 9:10 PM could not have been in the Captain's Cabin at any moment between 9:05 and 9:15: the Library is 8 minutes' walk away.

And the other way round: someone seen on the Promenade Deck at 9:30 PM could easily have been in the Captain's Cabin at 9:10, because the deck is only 5 minutes away.

TEST 2: MEANS

The captain was struck with a **brass anchor paperweight**, sold that night only at the Purser's Shop. The killer bought one.

How to check it: Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in the shop's sales book (File H). A finalist who is not in it fails this test.

TEST 3: ACCESS

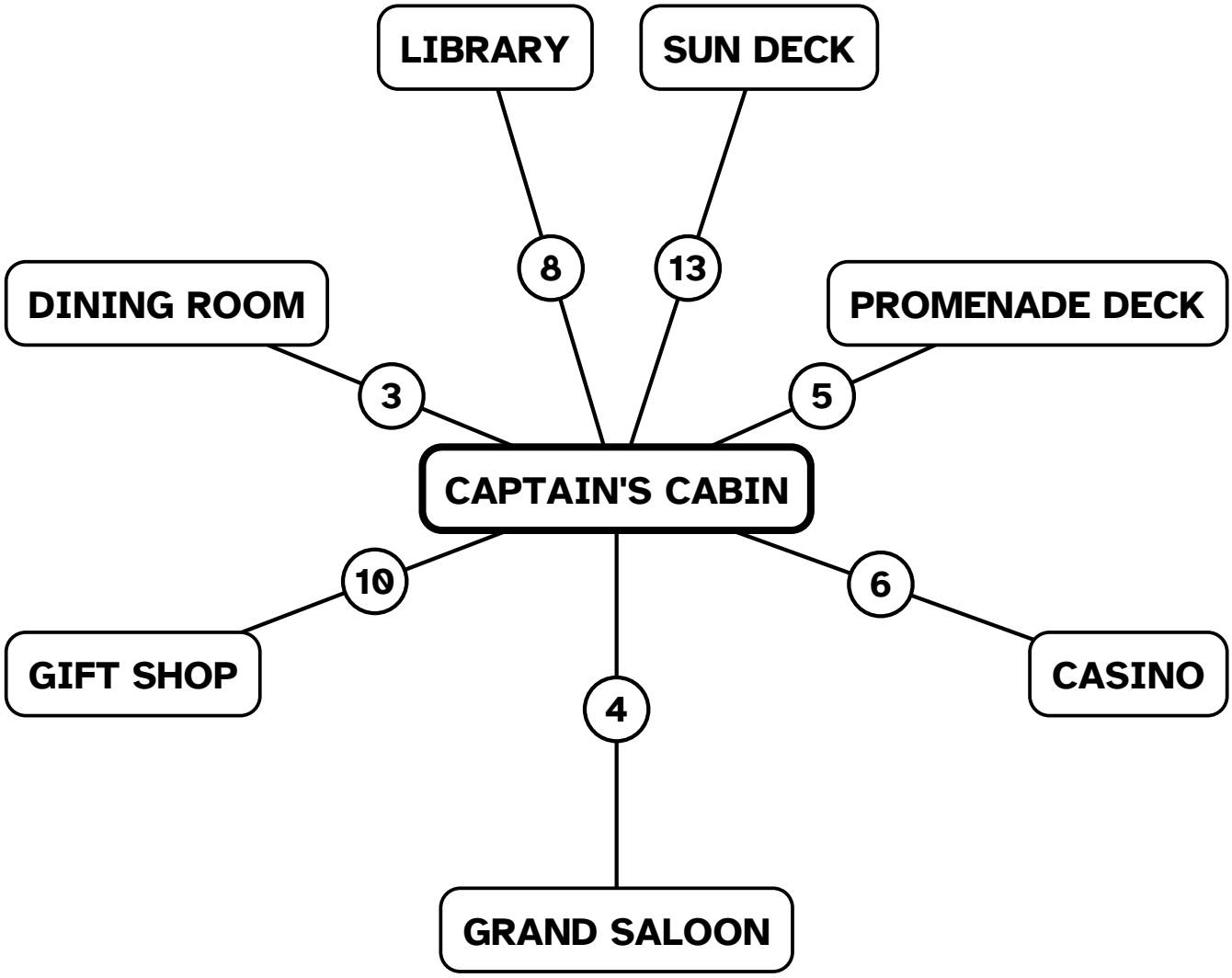
The corridor to the Captain's Cabin has a locked door, and only a red **Captain's Table key card** opens it. The killer had one.

How to check it: Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in the list of red key cards (File I). A finalist who is not on it fails this test.

Stuck? There are gentle hints for every test on page 39.

MAP OF THE MAGNOLIA QUEEN

The numbers show the walking time, in minutes, from each part of the boat to the Captain's Cabin.



Walking time to the Captain's Cabin:

Dining Room	3 min	Library	8 min
Grand Saloon	4 min	Gift Shop	10 min
Promenade Deck	5 min	Sun Deck	13 min
Casino	6 min		

FILE A · Dining Room Wine Orders

Some of the wine orders from the Dining Room, with the time and the ticket. The rest were paid in cash.

6:35 PM	ending 453	9:08 PM	ending 774
8:08 PM	ending 723	9:52 PM	ending 340
8:24 PM	ending 273	10:49 PM	ending 370
8:44 PM	ending 273	11:22 PM	ending 300

FILE B · Grand Saloon Dance Cards

Dance cards handed in at the Grand Saloon, with the time and the ticket. Not everyone danced.

6:18 PM	ending 300	8:26 PM	ending 673
7:10 PM	ending 297	9:02 PM	ending 950

FILE C · Promenade Deck Lemonade Stand

Receipts from the lemonade stand on the Promenade Deck, with the time and the ticket. Cash sales had no receipt.

7:13 PM	ending 453	10:35 PM	ending 673
7:53 PM	ending 142	10:46 PM	ending 673
8:07 PM	ending 472	11:15 PM	ending 072
8:23 PM	ending 723		

FILE D · Casino Chip Desk

Chips bought at the casino desk, with the time and the ticket. Only the card payments were written down.

6:37 PM	ending 297	10:22 PM	ending 774
6:49 PM	ending 340	11:00 PM	ending 340
9:57 PM	ending 554	11:17 PM	ending 750

FILE E · Library Sign-In Sheet

Passengers who borrowed a book signed in with the time and their ticket. Not everyone bothered to sign.

6:22 PM	ending 520	10:57 PM	ending 300
7:21 PM	ending 072	11:02 PM	ending 297
9:19 PM	ending 520	11:15 PM	ending 554
9:54 PM	ending 774	11:26 PM	ending 453

FILE F · Gift Shop Receipts

Receipts from the Gift Shop, with the time and the ticket. Cash sales had no receipt.

7:11 PM	ending 750	10:08 PM	ending 142
8:22 PM	ending 072		

FILE G · Sun Deck Blanket Loans

Passengers who borrowed a blanket on the Sun Deck were noted with the time and their ticket.

6:46 PM	ending 472	9:09 PM	ending 900
7:26 PM	ending 370	9:11 PM	ending 363
9:08 PM	ending 472	10:21 PM	ending 723
9:08 PM	ending 554	11:01 PM	ending 950
9:09 PM	ending 840	11:16 PM	ending 840

FILE H · Purser's Shop Sales Book

Every ticket, by its last three digits, that bought a brass anchor paperweight on Saturday night. This list is complete.

ending 023	ending 443	ending 760
ending 053	ending 472	ending 774
ending 072	ending 554	ending 840
ending 254	ending 673	ending 900
ending 273	ending 700	ending 950
ending 274	ending 720	ending 970
ending 340	ending 723	ending 972
ending 363	ending 750	

FILE I · Captain's Table Key Cards

Every ticket, by its last three digits, that was given a red Captain's Table key card. This list is complete.

ending 023	ending 072	ending 254
ending 053	ending 142	ending 273

continued on the next page

FILE I (continued)

ending 274
ending 297
ending 300
ending 363
ending 370
ending 443
ending 453
ending 554
ending 673
ending 700
ending 720
ending 723
ending 750
ending 760
ending 774
ending 950
ending 970
ending 972

THE DEDUCTION SHEET

Write each finalist's ticket number, then put a check mark if they pass the test and an X if they fail it. The killer is the only one with three check marks.

TICKET	TEST 1 Opportunity	TEST 2 Means	TEST 3 Access
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐
_____	☐	☐	☐

The killer is ticket number _____

Now work out your Verdict Code on page 42 to check your answer.

HINTS, PART A: A GENTLE NUDGE

Read these first. Each one tells you where to look, not what you will find.

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

Hint 1-A. Work with one finalist at a time. Find every record with the last three digits of their ticket in the visitor files, and note the place and the time.

TEST 2: MEANS

Hint 2-A. Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in File H. The list is in number order.

TEST 3: ACCESS

Hint 3-A. Look for the last three digits of each finalist's ticket in File I. The list is in number order.

HINTS, PART B: A STRONGER PUSH

Each hint tells you how many of your finalists fail that test.

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

Hint 1-B. Exactly 1 of your finalists fails this test.

TEST 2: MEANS

Hint 2-B. Exactly 1 of your finalists fails this test.

TEST 3: ACCESS

Hint 3-B. Exactly 1 of your finalists fails this test.

HINTS, PART C: THE ANSWERS

Only read this page if you are truly stuck. It explains which finalists fail each test, and why.

TEST 1: OPPORTUNITY

Hint 1-C. The finalist whose ticket ends in 472 was in the Sun Deck at 9:08 PM. The quickest walk from the Sun Deck to the Captain's Cabin takes 13 minutes, so they could not have been there at any moment between 9:05 PM and 9:15 PM.

TEST 2: MEANS

Hint 2-C. The finalist whose ticket ends in 370 is not in File H.

TEST 3: ACCESS

Hint 3-C. The finalist whose ticket ends in 472 is not in File I.

YOUR VERDICT CODE

When only one suspect is left, work out their **Verdict Code**. It is the only way to check your answer: the solution is never printed as a name anywhere in this book.

Step 1. Give every letter of the suspect's first and last name its number from the table below, and add them all up.

Step 2. Add the **last three digits** of the suspect's ticket number.

Step 3. Look up the total in the Verdict Table on the next page.

A	**B**	**C**	**D**	**E**	**F**	**G**	**H**	**I**	**J**	**K**	**L**	**M**
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
N	**O**	**P**	**Q**	**R**	**S**	**T**	**U**	**V**	**W**	**X**	**Y**	**Z**
14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26

Example (not a real suspect): **Ada Bell**, ticket **31207**.

Ada = A 1 + D 4 + A 1 = 6. Bell = B 2 + E 5 + L 12 + L 12 = 31. Name total = 6 + 31 = 37.

Last three digits of the ticket: 207. Verdict Code = 37 + 207 = **244**.

THE VERDICT TABLE

Find your Verdict Code in the list. If it is not here, check your adding up first, then go back to your last checkpoint.

103 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

125 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

134 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

136 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

144 Not quite. Check Clues 3 and 5 again.

156 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

310 Not quite. Check Clue 2 again.

314 Not quite. Check Clue 7 again.

316 Not quite. Check Clue 10 again.

321 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

372 Not quite. Check Clue 7 again.

387 Not quite. Check Clue 10 again.

401 Not quite. Check Clue 9 again.

429 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

451 Not quite. Check Clue 7 again.

472 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

481 So close! This finalist fails Test 2 (Means). Check it again.

505 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

533 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

556 Not quite. Check Clue 6 again.

574 So close! This finalist fails Test 1 (Opportunity) and Test 3 (Access). Check it again.

627 Not quite. Check Clue 8 again.

644 Not quite. Check Clue 4 again.

651 Not quite. Check Clue 5 again.

654 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

659 Not quite. Check Clue 1 again.

709 Not quite. Check Clue 2 again.

759 Not quite. Check Clue 2 again.

809 Not quite. Check Clue 9 again.

838 Not quite. Check Clues 2 and 9 again.

853 Not quite. Check Clue 8 again.

865 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

878 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

885 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

929 Not quite. Check Clue 8 again.

951 Not quite. Check Clue 3 again.

1029 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1058 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1100 CASE CLOSED! Turn to page 47.

1125 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1126 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1167 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1179 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

1180 No suspect left standing has this code. Go back to your last checkpoint.

STOP, DETECTIVE

Do not turn the page until the Verdict Table says **CASE CLOSED**.
The end of the story is on the other side.

CASE CLOSED

The old log turned up the next morning, wrapped in oilcloth inside a life ring locker at the stern, with the captain's notes folded between its pages.

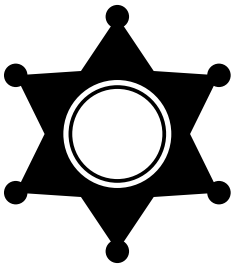
The notes explained everything. The "lost" log that had made the Magnolia Queen famous was a clever fake, and the captain had finally proved it. The person who had sold it to him years ago was on board that night, and was not going to let the truth come out in front of eight hundred passengers.

The Magnolia Queen still sails out of Natchez every Saturday night. The captain's wheel hangs in the Grand Saloon now, with a small brass plate underneath: "Forty years, and an honest log."

Eight hundred passengers, ten clues, three tests and one pen. You found the one person who could have done it.

Case closed. Well done, detective.

The killer was: _____



CERTIFICATE OF DETECTION

This certifies that

_____

cracked the case of

Death on the Magnolia Queen

and found the one killer among 800 suspects.

Date case closed _____

Days on the case _____

_____

Chief Inspector



THANK YOU, DETECTIVE

Thank you for spending your time with this case. We build every book so that it is fair, clear and easy on the eyes, and we hope it gave you some happy hours with a pen in your hand.

If you enjoyed it, there are more cases waiting for you, all in the same large, clear print.

THE CROSS OUT THE KILLER SERIES

LEVEL 1 — **Murder at the Antiques Fair**
Easy · 3,000 suspects

LEVEL 2 — **Death at the Model Railroad Show**
Medium · 5,000 suspects

LEVEL 3 — **Murder at the Ballpark**
Hard · 8,000 suspects

ONE SMALL FAVOR



If you enjoyed this case, would you leave a short review on Amazon? It only takes a minute, it helps other puzzle lovers find the book, and we read every single one.

Did you crack it? How long did it take? Which clue had you scratching your head? Just one thing: please, no spoilers.

How to leave a review

1. Open Amazon and go to **Returns & Orders**.
2. Find this book in your orders.
3. Choose **Write a product review**.

Thank you!